

Sweet Crumbs Bakery Website

Step-by-Step Guide to Creating External CSS Styling

A simple procedure for linking an HTML website to an external CSS stylesheet

1. What You Need

- A computer or laptop.
- Visual Studio Code (VS Code) or another code editor.
- The Sweet Crumbs Bakery website folder.
- The HTML pages: index.html, about.html, products.html, enquiry.html and contact.html.

2. Organise the Website Folder

First, make sure all your website files are kept inside one main folder. The folder should look like this:

Sweet Crumbs Bakery

```
|
|— index.html
|— about.html
|— products.html
|— enquiry.html
|— contact.html
|— style.css
```

The style.css file will contain all the design instructions for the website.

3. Open the Website in VS Code

1. Open Visual Studio Code.
2. Click File → Open Folder.
3. Find and select the Sweet Crumbs Bakery folder.
4. Click Select Folder.
5. The website files should appear on the left side of VS Code.

4. Open the index.html File

On the left side of VS Code, click index.html. This is the home page of the website.

Check that the HTML contains a link to the external CSS file inside the <head> section.

<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">

This line tells the browser to use the design rules stored in style.css.

5. Remove the Duplicate CSS Link

If the stylesheet link appears twice, keep only one copy. Your <head> section should contain the stylesheet link once.

6. Correct the Viewport Code

Make sure the viewport line says 'initial-scale', not 'intial-scale'. Use:

<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">

This helps the website display correctly on different screen sizes, including phones and computers.

7. Create the External CSS File

6. In VS Code, look at the Explorer on the left.
7. Right-click the Sweet Crumbs Bakery folder.
8. Choose New File.
9. Type style.css.
10. Press Enter.
11. The new style.css file should appear in the folder.

8. Add the CSS Styling

Open style.css and enter the following CSS code:

```
/* General Page Styling */
body {
    margin: 0;
    font-family: Arial, sans-serif;
    background-color: #fff8f0;
    color: #4b2e2e;
}

/* Header */
header {
    background-color: #d99a6c;
    color: white;
    text-align: center;
    padding: 30px;
}

header h1 {
    margin: 0;
    font-size: 36px;
}

header p {
    font-size: 18px;
    margin-top: 10px;
}

/* Navigation Bar */
nav {
    background-color: #5c4033;
    text-align: center;
```

```

        padding: 15px;
    }

    nav a {
        color: white;
        text-decoration: none;
        margin: 0 15px;
        font-weight: bold;
    }

    nav a:hover {
        color: #ffd6a5;
    }

    /* Main Content */
    main {
        min-height: 400px;
        display: flex;
        justify-content: center;
        align-items: center;
        padding: 40px;
    }

    /* Welcome Section */
    section {
        background-color: white;
        max-width: 700px;
        padding: 40px;
        text-align: center;
        border-radius: 10px;
        box-shadow: 0 4px 10px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.1);
    }

    section h2 {
        color: #b5651d;
        font-size: 28px;
    }

    section p {
        font-size: 17px;
        line-height: 1.6;
    }

    /* Products Link/Button */
    section a {
        display: inline-block;
        background-color: #d99a6c;
        color: white;
        text-decoration: none;
        padding: 12px 20px;
        margin-top: 15px;
        border-radius: 5px;
        font-weight: bold;
    }

    section a:hover {
        background-color: #b5651d;
    }

    /* Footer */
    footer {
        background-color: #5c4033;

```

```
color: white;
text-align: center;
padding: 15px;
}
```

9. Save the CSS File

After entering the CSS code, press Ctrl + S on the keyboard. This saves the external stylesheet.

10. Understand What the CSS Does

body – Controls the general font, background colour, text colour and page spacing.

header – Styles the bakery name and slogan at the top of the page.

nav – Creates the dark navigation bar.

nav a – Styles the Home, About Us, Products, Enquiry and Contact links.

nav a:hover – Changes the link colour when the mouse is placed over a navigation link.

main – Positions the main content in the centre of the page.

section – Creates the white content box around the welcome message.

section a – Turns the Products link into a button-like link.

footer – Styles the bottom section of the website.

11. Correct the Footer HTML

In index.html, check the copyright line. Remove the extra semicolon after ©;

<p>© 2026 Sweet Crumbs Bakery. All Rights Reserved.</p>

12. Save All Files

12. Press Ctrl + S while editing index.html.

13. Press Ctrl + S while editing style.css.

14. Make sure both files are saved inside the same Sweet Crumbs Bakery folder.

13. Open and Test the Website

15. Find index.html in the Sweet Crumbs Bakery folder.

16. Double-click index.html, or right-click it and choose Open with a browser.

17. The website should open in your browser.

18. Check that the header has the bakery colours and centred text.

19. Check that the navigation bar is styled.

20. Move your mouse over the navigation links to test the hover effect.

21. Check that the welcome section is centred and has a white background.

22. Click View Our Products to check that products.html opens.

14. If the Styling Does Not Appear

- Check that the file is named exactly style.css and not style.css.txt.
- Check that style.css is in the same folder as index.html.
- Check that the HTML says <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">.
- Make sure you saved the CSS file.
- Refresh the browser using Ctrl + R.
- If necessary, close the browser page and open index.html again.

15. Final Folder Check

Before submitting the website, your folder should contain:

- index.html
- about.html
- products.html
- enquiry.html
- contact.html
- style.css

16. Final Result

The HTML files provide the structure and content of the Sweet Crumbs Bakery website, while style.css provides the appearance and layout. Because the CSS is stored in a separate file, the same stylesheet can be linked to the other HTML pages so that the whole website has a consistent design.